BUILD6™ — Ambassador Christian School
Week 14: Mentorship + Informational Conversation

Portfolio Artifact

Date: November 19, 2026

BUILD6 Stage: LAUNCH™

Experience Alignment: Mentorship and informational conversation practice; Matthew Banker / college-athletics readiness remains proposed until confirmed.

Portfolio Artifact

Students save the artifact, explain what it shows, and connect it to their Capstone story.

Locked Weekly Curriculum

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Proprietary Future Ready™ / BUILD6™ program material.

Future Ready™ · Week 14

MENTORSHIP + INFORMATIONAL CONVERSATION

Relationships · Curiosity · Listening · Follow-Up · Professional Initiative

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How can I build relationships with people who can help me learn — without treating networking like asking for a job?

THIS WEEK

Last week, you identified people you may need on your Decision Team.

You considered people who could help you think about:

- career and work
- money
- education
- life and values
- athletics
- health and well-being

This week, you move from identifying people to actually learning how to build professional relationships.

A mentor is not someone whose job is to solve your future.

A strong professional relationship begins with:

CURIOSITY → PREPARATION → LISTENING → FOLLOW-UP → ACTION

PART 1 · RETURN TO MY DECISION TEAM

Review Week 13.

Someone I identified who could help me learn:

_____

What area could this person help me understand?

[ ] Career / Work

[ ] Education

[ ] Money

[ ] Athletics

[ ] Life / Values

[ ] Health / Well-Being

[ ] Other: _____

Why this person or type of person?

_____

_____

PART 2 · WHAT DO I ACTUALLY WANT TO LEARN?

Do not begin with:

"Can you help me?"

Get specific.

Something I am trying to understand:

_____

_____

A decision I may eventually need to make:

_____

_____

A pathway I want to understand better:

_____

_____

A skill I want to build:

_____

_____

An experience I want to learn from:

_____

_____

PART 3 · WHO IS THE RIGHT PERSON?

One person does not need to know everything.

PERSON OR TYPE OF PERSON

_____

Industry / role / experience:

_____

What could this person realistically help me understand?

_____

_____

What should I NOT expect this person to do for me?

_____

_____

PART 4 · RESEARCH BEFORE YOU REACH OUT

Before asking for someone's time, learn what you can first.

Person:

_____

Organization / company:

_____

Role:

_____

What I already know:

_____

_____

Something I learned through research:

_____

_____

Something I still cannot answer without talking to them:

_____

_____

PART 5 · MY PROFESSIONAL INTRODUCTION

A strong introduction should be short.

MY NAME

_____

SOMETHING RELEVANT ABOUT ME

_____

WHAT I AM INTERESTED IN LEARNING

_____

WHY I WANTED TO SPEAK WITH THIS PERSON

_____

PUT IT TOGETHER

My name is:

_____

I am currently:

_____

I am interested in learning more about:

_____

I wanted to speak with you because:

_____

_____

PART 6 · DO NOT ASK FOR A JOB

Compare these approaches.

Weak:

"Can you help me get a job?"

Stronger:

"I'd like to understand more about how you entered this field and what you think someone my age should learn now."

Why is the second approach stronger?

_____

_____

What does it communicate about the student?

_____

_____

PART 7 · BUILD AT LEAST EIGHT QUESTIONS

Your questions should create information you can actually use.

PATH

1. _____

DECISIONS

2. _____

SKILLS

3. _____

CHALLENGES

4. _____

MISTAKES

5. _____

WORK

6. _____

ADVICE

7. _____

NEXT STEPS

8. _____

PART 8 · MAKE THE QUESTIONS BETTER

Check your questions.

Are any answerable through a basic internet search?

[ ] Yes

[ ] No

Are any too broad?

[ ] Yes

[ ] No

Are any really asking the person to make a decision for you?

[ ] Yes

[ ] No

Are your questions specific enough to create useful information?

[ ] Yes

[ ] Not yet

Rewrite one weak question:

BEFORE:

_____

AFTER:

_____

_____

PART 9 · CHOOSE YOUR BEST FIVE

QUESTION 1

_____

Why this question matters:

_____

QUESTION 2

_____

Why this question matters:

_____

QUESTION 3

_____

Why this question matters:

_____

QUESTION 4

_____

Why this question matters:

_____

QUESTION 5

_____

Why this question matters:

_____

PART 10 · LISTENING IS THE WORK

Your job is not to race through five questions.

Listen.

Something I did not expect:

_____

_____

Something I want to understand better:

_____

_____

Something that connects to my own experience:

_____

_____

Something I disagree with or need to think about:

_____

_____

PART 11 · THE FOLLOW-UP QUESTION

A follow-up proves you were listening.

Something the person said:

_____

What I want to understand better:

_____

My follow-up question:

_____

_____

PART 12 · ADVICE IS NOT AN ORDER

A mentor can give advice.

You still need judgment.

Advice I received:

_____

_____

Why might this advice be useful?

_____

_____

What context might be different for me?

_____

_____

Do I need another perspective before acting?

[ ] Yes

[ ] No

Why?

_____

_____

PART 13 · WHAT WILL I DO WITH THE ADVICE?

One piece of advice I want to act on:

_____

_____

My specific next action:

_____

_____

When will I do it?

_____

How will I know I followed through?

_____

PART 14 · SHOULD THIS RELATIONSHIP CONTINUE?

Not every professional conversation becomes mentorship.

Ask:

Did I learn something valuable?

[ ] Yes

[ ] No

Is this someone whose judgment I respect?

[ ] Yes

[ ] Not sure

Is there a legitimate reason to stay connected?

[ ] Yes

[ ] No

Could I follow up after taking action on their advice?

[ ] Yes

[ ] No

What would make continued contact appropriate?

_____

_____

PART 15 · ASK FOR THE NEXT CONVERSATION — NOT THE REST OF YOUR LIFE

If appropriate:

A professional next-step request could sound like:

_____

_____

Example:

"I appreciate your advice. Would it be okay if I stayed in touch and followed up after I learn more about this?"

My version:

_____

_____

PART 16 · PROFESSIONAL CLOSE

How will I end the conversation respectfully?

_____

_____

What should I thank the person for specifically?

_____

_____

PART 17 · THANK-YOU MESSAGE

Keep it:

- specific
- brief
- professional
- connected to the actual conversation

SUBJECT OR OPENING

_____

THANK YOU

_____

_____

SOMETHING I LEARNED

_____

_____

ACTION I PLAN TO TAKE

_____

_____

CLOSE

_____

PART 18 · RELATIONSHIP MAP

Return to your Decision Team.

CAREER / WORK

Who could I learn from?

_____

Next action:

_____

MONEY

Who could I learn from?

_____

Next action:

_____

EDUCATION

Who could I learn from?

_____

Next action:

_____

LIFE / VALUES

Who could I learn from?

_____

Next action:

_____

ATHLETICS

Who could I learn from?

_____

Next action:

_____

HEALTH / WELL-BEING

Who could I learn from?

_____

Next action:

_____

PART 19 · RELATIONSHIPS ARE TWO-WAY

A professional relationship should not only be about what you can receive.

How can I show appreciation?

_____

How can I demonstrate that I used someone's advice?

_____

How can I respect their time?

_____

What can make someone WANT to continue helping me?

_____

_____

PART 20 · REPUTATION + RELATIONSHIPS

Think back to Week 13.

The reputation I said I want to build:

_____

How does following up support that reputation?

_____

_____

How does being prepared support that reputation?

_____

_____

How does doing what I said I would do support that reputation?

_____

_____

WEEK 14 REFLECTION

BEFORE THIS WEEK...

I thought networking meant:

_____

_____

NOW...

I think professional relationship building means:

_____

_____

The best question I asked:

_____

The most useful advice I heard:

_____

The follow-up question that taught me more:

_____

One action I will take:

_____

One relationship that may be worth maintaining:

_____

One person still missing from my Decision Team:

_____

FUTURE READY™ PASSPORT EVIDENCE

Save:

MY PROFESSIONAL INTRODUCTION

_____

MY BEST QUESTION

_____

ONE FOLLOW-UP QUESTION

_____

ONE PIECE OF ADVICE

_____

ONE ACTION COMMITMENT

_____

MY THANK-YOU MESSAGE

_____

ONE RELATIONSHIP I MAY CONTINUE

_____

CAPSTONE CONNECTION

Keep:

- one person who helped you
- one strong question
- one unexpected answer
- one follow-up question
- one piece of advice
- one action you took
- one relationship worth maintaining
- one example of professional follow-through

Opportunities often begin with relationships.

Relationships grow when you show curiosity, preparation, appreciation and follow-through.

WEEK 14 CLOSE

I WANTED TO LEARN...

_____

I ASKED...

_____

I HEARD...

_____

I FOLLOWED UP...

_____

I WILL ACT BY...

_____

THIS RELATIONSHIP MAY MATTER BECAUSE...

_____

ASK. LISTEN. ACT. FOLLOW UP. BUILD THE RELATIONSHIP.

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